

Scammed!

Characters:

Anirudh: Indian male about 26 year old

Entities: Unknown Humanoids

INT. ROOFTOP ROOM - EVENING

The scene opens with our main character taking a power nap on his desk. A Landline phone on his right. Mobile phone on his left.

His Mobile rings. He looks up and sees the caller ID: Supervisor sir

He jumps up, clears his throat and picks up the call.

SUPERVISOR

Hello! Anirudh, where are you? Tum abhi tak Clocked-in kyon nhi ho? 5:00 baje shift start hai na tumhara?

ANIRUDH

Hello, Yes sir. Mai bus Clock-in kar hi rha tha. Thoda late ho gaya sorry.

Starts fiddling with the PC

SUPERVISOR

Pehle hi din late join kar rhe ho? Majak chal rha hai kya yahan par?

ANIRUDH

Arre nhi nhi sir, kya baat kar rhe hain. Koi majak nhi chal rha.

SUPERVISOR

Fir mujhe kyon call karke tumko batana pad rha hai Clock-in karne ke liye?

ANIRUDH

Sir bus aaj bhar late hua hu. Aage se pakka nhi hoga.

SUPERVISOR

(Condesendingly)

Chalo, maan li tumhari baat. Waise aaj kaun se script par baithe ho?

ANIRUDH

Aaj mai NBI waale script par hu. And Token harvest karna hai, Marauder script use karke.

SUPERVISOR
Kitne total leads hain tumhare
sheet par aaj?

ANIRUDH
Around 30 hai sir.

SUPERVISOR
Shaam ke 6:00 baj rhe hain. 20
Harvest chahiye aaj, 20 se 1 kam
hua toh kal se doosra job dekh
lena, theek hai?

ANIRUDH
Nhi nhi sir. Ho jaayega. Maine
pehle bhi kiya hai. Toh mujhe
confidence hai.

SUPERVISOR
Ye confidence hai ya
overconfidence?

ANIRUDH
Confidence hi hai sir. Agar
emotional log mil gayein toh jaldi
hi ho jaayega.

SUPERVISOR
Chalo, ye bhi maan liya. Aur
tumhare end se koi sawaal?

ANIRUDH
Nhi sir, mere end se sab sorted
hai.

SUPERVISOR
Chalo fir shuru kar do. Muhrat
nikla ja rha hai.

ANIRUDH
Ji, abhi start kar rha hu.

Call Disconnects. Anirudh curses under his breath. Then puts
his phone down and Clocks-in. After that opens the CRM for
the job.

Anirudh downloads a csv style file that lists targets for him
for today.

ANIRUDH
Chalo fer. Inspector sahab, ready
ho jaayiye.

Anirudh says to himself as he cracks his fingers. Pick the
first target in the list. Dials the number using the CRM
tool. The call connects after a few seconds.

ANIRUDH

Hello, main Inspector Vijaya bol rha hu National Bureau of Investigation ke Cybercrime Division se. Kya meri baat Mr. Sahaj Patel se ho rhi hai?

CALLEE

Ji mera naam hi Sahaj Patel hai.

ANIRUDH

Mr. Patel aap meri baat dhyaan se sunein aur call disconnect na karein. Isse pehle mai call ka reason bataun, mai aapse kuch basic details confirm karunga.

CALLEE

Hua kya hai bhai sahab?

ANIRUDH

Ye phone number 981000005 aapka hi personal number hai right?

CALLEE

Ji mera hi number hai ye.

ANIRUDH

Aapka address Ananda Vihaar, Noida ka hai.

CALLEE

Ji, par aap ye sab kyon mujhe bata rhe hain.

ANIRUDH

Patelji, ek investigation me ek overseas Bank account saamne aaya hai jisse ki aapka phone number aur PAN number linked hai.

CALLEE

(Voice raising)

Kya baat kar rhe hain? Kaun sa account? Mera koi overseas account nhi hai.

ANIRUDH

Sun toh lijiye poori baat. Humare records ke mutabik apka hi phone aur PAN number linked hai uss account se. And uspe 15 crore se jyada ke fraud transactions hue hain.

CALLEE

(Defensively)

Aise kaise maan le aapki baat. 15 crore koi majak hai? Itna bada amount aaj tak aaj tak dekha nhi humne, aap keh rhe hain mere account me hai?

ANIRUDH

Aapke inkaar karne se humare records nhi badal jaayenge Patelji. Filhaal toh investigation hoga uske baad hi pata chalega kitna doodh hai aur kitna paani.

CALLEE

Arre kya doodh paani kar rhe hain? Aap log aise kisi pe bhi, kuch bhi ilzaam laga denge? Koi system naam ki cheez hai ki nhi?

ANIRUDH

Dekhiye saara cheez system ke hisaab se hi hoga. Aapke naam ka Arrest Warrant issue hua hai jo aapke address pe Police lekar jaayegi. Uske baad poochtaach me aage ka khulaasa hoga.

CALLEE

(Getting Agitated)

Aise kaise arrest kar sakte hain mujhe? Matlab account hoga kisi mantri ke bete ka, aur mujhe sirf bali ka bakra banaya ja rha hai. Mere paas bhi licensi revolver hai, goli maar denge jo bhi faaltu arrest karne aayega mujhe.

ANIRUDH

Patelji, Patelji aap apna hi maamla kharab kar rhe hain. Ye call record ho rhi hai, samjhe aap?

CALLEE

(Highly Agitated)

Aur kitna kharab hoga maamla. Agar jail jaayenge toh murder ke liye jaayenge. Kisi aise jurm ke liye nhi jo humne kiya hi nhi.

ANIRUDH

Shaant ho jaayiye pehle aap thoda. Aur suniye meri baat.

CALLEE

Arre kya shaant ho jaaye? Aap ghatiya ilzaam lagaye ja rhe hain mere upar.

ANIRUDH

Patelji fir aap bole ja rhe hain. Meri baat sun toh lijiye pehle. Agar aapko lagta hai ki aapki identity ka misuse hua toh aap cooperate kijiye humare saath. Hum secondary verification ka process shuru kar sakte hain.

CALLEE

Haan, hua hai misuse. Hum aapko dus baar bata chuke hain ki humara koi account nhi hai, jisme ye - 15 crore pada hai.

ANIRUDH

Patelji mai aapse request kar rha hu thoda thande dimaag se kaam lijiye abhi. Mai samajh rha hu identity ka misuse hua ho sakta hai.

CALLEE

Ho sakta nhi, hua hai. Aur dimaag aapne mera kharab kar rakha hai aur bol rhe hain shaant rahiye.

ANIRUDH

Patelji ab jyada ho rha hai. Mai aapko last oppertunity de rha hu, aap cooperate kijiye humare saath. Mai secondary verification ka request abhi bhi daal sakta hu.

CALLEE

Ji mai shaant hu. Bataiye kya karna hai.

Anirudh launches Marauder Script.

ANIRUDH

Aapka poora naam Sahaj Kumar Patel hai, right?

CALLEE

Ji, Sahaj Kumar Patel.

ANIRUDH

Theek hai. Apna Data of Birth ek baar bataiye mai record se match karunga.

CALLEE

28 March, 1965

ANIRUDH

Theek hai, ab mai aapka phone number verify karunga. Uske liye system ek verification code generate karega. Aapko woh code jor se padna hai taaki mai usko records ke saath match kara sakun. Samajh gaye aap?

CALLEE

Kaisa code?

Anirudh initiates Marauder Script

ANIRUDH

Dekhiye ek verification code aaya hoga aapke mobile pe.

CALLEE

Han, aaya abhi. Six Four Seven One One Five

ANIRUDH

Ji ek minute.

Anirudh enters the code in the "Context Data" input field of Marauder Script and hits "Submit".

ANIRUDH

Ji dhanyawaad Patelji. Aapke records theek dikh rhe hain. Maine secondary verification ke liye application daal diya hai. Aur abhi ke liye aapka Warrant wapass liya ja rha hai.

CALLEE

Abhi ke liye matlab? Permanent wapass hona chahiye na?

ANIRUDH

Permanent wapass ho jaayega ek baar verification ka process poora hone dijiye. Aur abhi kyunki investigation ongoing hai toh aapka number surveillance pe rahega. Isiliye aapke safety ke liye best rahega aap apna phone switch off kar dijiye. Samajh rhe hain aap?

CALLEE

Humare cooperation ke bawajood surveillance kyon?

ANIRUDH

Dekhiye ye SOP hai, investigation ke dauraan sirf surveillance rehta hai. Filhaal aapse itna hi share kar sakta hu. Baaki case confidential hai toh abhi iske baare me kisi se bhi discuss mat kijiyege. Verification poori hone ke baad aapko ek Clearance Letter receive ho jaayega aapke address par.

CALLEE

Woh sab toh theek hai but mujhe lag rha hai kuch toh gadbad hai.

ANIRUDH

Gadbad tha ab sab theek ho jaayega. Abhi aap phone rakhiye aur switch off kar dijiye. Samajh gaye aap?

CALLEE

Baat kuch hajam nhi ho rha hai mujhe.

ANIRUDH

Ho jaayega hajam. Aapka aur time nhi lunga, isiliye shubh raatri.

CALLEE

Chaliye dekhte hain.

Satisfied. Anirudh hangs up. Marks lead as "Harvest Complete". Celebrates quietly. And looks at the next lead.

He checks the number and enters it in the Dialer. Pauses for a second. Takes a deep breath and hits Dial.

CALLEE

Hello?

ANIRUDH

Hello, main Inspector Vijaya bol rha hu National Bureau of Investigation ke Cybercrime Division se. Kya meri baat Mr. Gopiraj se ho rhi hai?

CALLEE

Ji nhi, mai unka deta bol rha hu. Kya chahiye aapko?

ANIRUDH

Gopiraj ji ko phone dijiyega mujhe unse hi baat karni hai.

CALLEE

(Sternly)

Ye toh nhi ho sakta bhai sahab.
Pitaji abhi busy hain. Aap mujhse
hi baat kijiye na.

ANIRUDH

Accha? Jinse baat ho rhi hai unka
naam?

CALLEE

Aapki baat desh ke Pradhaan Mantri
se ho rhi hai. Humara naam aapko
Google pe mil jaayega.

ANIRUDH

(Getting Annoyed)

1 min. Kya tareeka hai ye baat
karne ka? Tumhaare pitaji jail ja
sakte hain aur tumko mazak soojh
rha hai?

CALLEE

Han kya? Kis khushi me woh jail ja
sakte hain jara hume bhi bataiye.

ANIRUDH

Betaji shayad tum nhi samjhe. Hum
NBI, Cybercrime Division se
Inspector Vijaya bol rhe hain.
Hume tumhare pitaji se urgently
baat karni ek case ke regarding.

CALLEE

Nhi Inspector ji aap nhi samjhe.
Mujhe bohot acche se pata hai aap
kaun bol rhe hain. Waise toh mujhe
shauk nhi hai apna time waste
karne ka, lekin aapne toh suspense
bana diya. Ab toh mujhe janna hai
ki kaun se case ke baare me aapko
papa se baat karna hai.

ANIRUDH

Case details mai tumhaare saath
nhi share kar sakta. Lekin behtar
yeh hoga apna papa se meri baat
kara do. Nhi toh tumhaare liye bhi
problem ho sakta hai.

CALLEE

Phone toh nhi de rha mai Papa ko.
Baaki hum bhi thoda jaane kya
problem hoga.

ANIRUDH

(Annoyed)

Kya problem hoga jaanna hai na?
Theek hai, Ek sensitive
investigation me cooperate na
karna bhi ek jurm hai. Mai
tumhaare against ek warrant issue
karwata hu, chalega?

CALLEE

(Laughs loudly)

Accha? Aukaat hai itna tumhaare
paas jo warrant issue karega? Arre
hai toh laga Aatankwaad ka case!
Tab jaanu tu hai koi NBI waala.

ANIRUDH

(Furious)

Ruk tujhe toh batana padega. Tu
aise nhi maane ga na? Tere aur
tere baap ke, dono ke naam pe
Arrest Warrant issue karwata hu.
Fir lockup me milenge aur dekhenge
tujhe tab bhi hasi aati hai ya
nhi.

CALLEE

(Laughing)

Hah! Maza hi aa gaya. Maere
against arrest waarrant issue ho
gaya, kyon ki mujhe hasi bohot
aati hai!

ANIRUDH

Abhi toh aur hasi aayegi. Tu ruk,
tere naam pe jitne cases milte
hain na, sab kholta hu mai. Tu
dekh bus.

CALLEE

Aur tere naam pe Only Fans kholta
hu mai. 20 Rs dekar nachaunga
tujhe.

ANIRUDH

(Very angry)

Beta ye saara call record ho rha
hai. Government officer ke saath
battameezi tu kar rha hai na. Kya
kya hoga tere saath tujhe abhi
samajh me nhi aa rha hai.

CALLEE

Arre ja jo ukhaarna hai ukhaar le.
Koi government officer nhi hai tu.
Bohot dekhe hain tere jaise.

ANIRUDH

Kya dekha hai be? Aaja mere ghar
pe aur bohot kuch dikhata hu
tujhe.

CALLEE

Aa gaya na apne asli aukaat pe?
Arre kya gunda banega re tu?

ANIRUDH

Only Fans pe tera baap naachta hai
na 20 Rs ke liye?

CALLEE

Arre ja kisi aur ka dimaag kharab
kar. Itna phokat ka time nhi hai
mera paas.

Call disconnects abruptly cutting Anirudh off. He mutters something to himself angrily while shaking his fist. He gets up and walks for a minute to release his frustration. Then returns to his workstation to mark the lead as failed. Checks another lead and hesitates for some time. His phone suddenly rings, with Caller ID: Supervisor Sir.

[Scene Note - Background Event]

[A strange hand is barely visible coming from behind an obstacle at a distance outside the window. Protagonist does not notice it or reacts to it. It is framed in a way that it's really hard to notice it. Stays for a few shots before disappearing. Always at the side or at the corner of the frame.]

SUPERVISOR

Hello Anirudh.

ANIRUDH

Yes, hello sir.

SUPERVISOR

I was reviewing your last call.
What happened? You lost your cool
too soon.

ANIRUDH

He already knew, sir. It was out
of my hands.

SUPERVISOR

No Anirudh. Your approach was not
correct. When he mentioned it's
the son you should change tactics
and find some reason to call back
later or convince him to give
phone to his father. But instead
you doubled down on threats. You
cannot lose your cool like this.

ANIRUDH

I understand sir. I will try my best.

SUPERVISOR

Don't sabotage leads like this. If you can't handle let us know. There is no shortage of people who want to do this.

ANIRUDH

No no, sir. And I promise I will be more careful.

SUPERVISOR

Consider this your final warning. You may continue.

ANIRUDH

Yes sir.

Anirudh takes a deep breath and starts calling the numbers. Call Montage begins.

INT. ROOFTOP ROOM - MIDDLE OF THE NIGHT

Anirudh looks at the Sheet and notices that there have been some modifications on it. He notices that some of the previous leads he had spoken to and marked as Collection in Progress have a strange note "DECEASED" next to them. He does not remember putting those.

ANIRUDH

What is this? When did I ever write this?

He scrolls up and down the sheet. He is confused.

INT. ROOFTOP ROOM - LATE NIGHT

Anirudh looks at the final entry in the Sheet. It says Anirudh G. He is shocked. He picks up his phone and calls his manager.

ANIRUDH

Hello sir.

SUPERVISOR

Yes Anirudh, what is it?

ANIRUDH

Sir, why is my name on this list?

SUPERVISOR

What do you mean? Why would your name be there in the list?

ANIRUDH

Sir, it says Anirudh G and has what looks like my number.

SUPERVISOR

So, you are telling me you are the only Anirudh G on the whole planet.

ANIRUDH

No sir, but it looks like my name and number.

SUPERVISOR

Why don't you call it and find out?

ANIRUDH

Sir, I have bad feeling about this.

SUPERVISOR

Listen, do me a favour. Just call all leads and submit the report. I don't have time for this.

ANIRUDH

Please sir, really strange things are happening. I am really scared.

SUPERVISOR

(Voice getting Garbled)
Anirudh just finish the list...
You need to finish the list...

ANIRUDH

What sir?

Call disconnects.

ANIRUDH

Hello? Hello?

Anirudh puts the phone down.

PHONE

(Garbled Voice)
Finish the list

ANIRUDH

What the fuck? What was that?

Scared, he looks around the room and the door. He gets up, picks up the door key and goes near the door. He tries opening but sees that the lock is on the other side of the door. He realizes he is trapped in the room.

ANIRUDH

Oh crap. What do I do? What the fuck!

Anirudh picks up his phone and dials Emergency number. Someone picks up on the other side.

SUPERVISOR

Hello, Anirudh? Why are you calling me again? Are you done with the list?

ANIRUDH

What? No sir! I didn't call you. I called Emergency no.

SUPERVISOR

Are you out of your mind? Why did you call Emergency? Something stupid going on in your mind?

ANIRUDH

No Sir! I am trapped in my room. I need help sir. I don't know what to do!

SUPERVISOR

(Voice getting Garbled)

I told you to finish the List...
Just finish the List...

Anirudh hangs up. He grabs his head in distress. He slowly approaches his PC. Then opens the dialer and types in the number. Hesitantly presses Dial.

Silence hangs for 15-20 seconds. Then his personal phone starts ringing. Caller ID says Unknown Number. Anirudh slowly picks up.

ANIRUDH

Hel...Hello?

VOICE

Hello, this is Inspector Vijaya
Speaking from the Cybercrime
Division of National Bureau of
Investigation. Am I speaking to
Mr. Anirudh?

ANIRUDH

(Panicking)

What? Who is this.

VOICE

This is Inspector Vijaya, I have
been assigned to your case file
regarding...

ANIRUDH

No no no, this is not possible.
This cannot be possible.

Anirudh drops his phone. Entities enter his room. Anirudh
hides.

VOICE

Hello sir, am I audible? Hello?

Entities surround Anirudh, camera fades.

FADE OUT.